écentic — User Personas

Last updated: 2026-06-02

These are the four merchant-side personas écentic is built for. They are not consumer personas — those are modelled separately inside the simulation engine itself (budget shopper, premium shopper, eco-conscious shopper). The personas below are the people who buy, install, and use écentic.

Persona 1: The Indie Founder

Name (composite): Anya, 31 **Role:** Founder and head of everything at a 7-person DTC brand on Shopify **GMV:** €800K / year **Geography:** Berlin (markets across DACH and UK)

Job to be done

"Make sure my brand shows up when people ask AI for recommendations in my category — without me having to learn a whole new optimisation discipline."

Day-in-the-life pain

Sees GPTBot, ClaudeBot in her traffic logs and doesn't know what to do about it

Spends Saturdays in front of ChatGPT testing whether her brand shows up; sometimes it does, sometimes a competitor does, and she can't predict which

Knows that AI shopping is "the next thing" but can't justify a full-time SEO/AI hire

Reads Twitter and Lenny's Newsletter; treats tooling decisions as 24-hour decisions

What she needs from écentic

One-click install (no developer)

Free scan that gives her one concrete reason her hero product loses to her main competitor

Pricing under €150/mo (so she can sign up without asking anyone)

Honest, plain-English explanation of *why* she's losing — not jargon, not GEO marketing

How she discovers us

Shopify App Store organic search ("AI optimisation")

YouTube tutorial from a creator she trusts

A Twitter/X thread about Cyber Week 2025 agent traffic

The free public UCP validator (she enters her domain, gets a report, then installs)

How she pays

Credit card on Shopify billing, monthly

Upgrade decisions happen in-product, not in a sales conversation

Will churn if she logs in for 30 days and doesn't see a clear "we shipped X fixes" report

Tier fit

Connect ($149/mo) initially, upgrades to Compete ($499/mo) within 60 days if she likes the auto-publish loop.

Persona 2: The Growth Lead at a DTC Brand

Name (composite): Marcus, 34 **Role:** Head of Growth at a $5M GMV beauty brand on Shopify Plus **GMV:** €4M / year **Geography:** New York (sells to US + UK)

Job to be done

"Find the next 5% lift in revenue. AI shopping is a channel that didn't exist last year — I want to be early."

Day-in-the-life pain

Has reduced returns on Meta ads, looking for new channels

Already invested in conversion rate optimisation, email, retention — running out of easy wins

Reports to a founder who wants to know "what's next" every two weeks

Saw a competitor get recommended by ChatGPT and immediately Slacked the team about it

What he needs from écentic

Numbers, not vibes. Specific win-rate deltas per SKU per model.

A weekly delta report he can forward to his founder ("Here's what we shipped this week, here's what moved.")

Auto-publish that he can review and approve, not unsupervised changes

A path to API access so he can pull data into his internal BI

How he discovers us

Word-of-mouth from a peer in another DTC brand

Newsletter / podcast mention (Modern Retail, Lenny's, DTC Newsletter)

Outbound from écentic's GTM Lead with a personalised scan report attached

How he pays

Annual contract at 15% discount on Compete or Dominate

Procurement involvement is light — he can sign up to ~€10K/year on his own authority

Renewal decision sits with him; he treats it like any other tooling renewal

Tier fit

Compete ($499/mo) for the first 3–6 months, upgrades to Dominate ($999/mo) when he wants persona-based simulation and the API. May commission a one-off catalog audit before a major Q4 launch.

Persona 3: The Agency Operator

Name (composite): Olivia, 38 **Role:** Director of Performance at a Shopify Plus partner agency **Manages:** 12 merchant clients, €5M–€40M GMV each **Geography:** London

Job to be done

“Bring my clients a credible answer to ‘what are you doing about AI shopping’ that I can deliver as a managed service.”

Day-in-the-life pain

Clients are starting to ask about AI agents and she has no good answer

Competing against agencies that are pitching “agentic commerce” as a service line — she needs the tooling

Doesn’t want to build a tool — wants to white-label or resell something that exists

Margins are thin; she needs a 20%+ resale margin to justify selling it

What she needs from écentic

A way to manage multiple merchant accounts from one login

Shareable scan reports she can rebrand for client meetings

Volume discount or agency tier pricing

A clear story about how écentic differs from GEO tools (which her competitors are pitching)

How she discovers us

Shopify Plus partner directory and partner Slack

Outbound from écentic’s agency partner outreach

A client of hers (Marcus, above) recommends she try it

How she pays

Agency-managed contract — typically annual, €15K–€30K total covering multiple client accounts

Co-marketing arrangement: she promotes écentic to her client roster, gets 20% resale margin

Wants joint case studies for her own marketing

Tier fit

Compete ($499/mo) × multiple client accounts, with an agency-tier discount. Multi-account billing handled at the agency level.

Persona 4: The Enterprise Operator

Name (composite): Karim, 45 **Role:** VP, Digital Commerce at a Tier-1 retail brand (think Carrefour, eBay, Inditex) **GMV:** €50M+ / year for his line of business **Geography:** Paris, with EU and US scope

Job to be done

“Get my organisation a defensible, board-presentable view of where we stand on agent-mediated commerce — before our CEO asks.”

Day-in-the-life pain

Has been asked by the C-suite about agent commerce; has no operational answer

Internal teams are exploring multiple AI initiatives in silos

Procurement and security teams will scrutinise any vendor heavily

Needs to prove ROI before he can scale spend

What he needs from écentic

A pilot that is structured (clear KPI, clear timeline, clear go/no-go gate)

A vendor that is not a single-person shop, with a credible compliance posture (SOC 2 in progress, EU data residency live, GDPR DPA ready)

Co-published, mutually approved case study he can show internally

Aggregate industry benchmarks to position his organisation

A path to a meaningful annual contract after the pilot

How he discovers us

Plug and Play corporate ventures introduction

Payment-network partnership (Visa Trusted Agent Protocol angle for Carrefour specifically)

Industry-conference panels and Visa Merchant Observatory positioning

Direct outbound from écentic’s CEO

How he pays

12-week pilot, free for the first cohort (2026); €15K–€50K from 2027 onwards

Annual contract at €25K–€75K Year 1

Procurement, legal, and IT security all sign off

Renewal decision goes through a vendor review committee

Tier fit

Enterprise, custom-priced. Multi-stakeholder sale cycle of 3–6 months.

How these personas drive product decisions

Anya drives the App Store onboarding flow, the free scan as lead magnet, and the pricing of Connect tier.

Marcus drives the auto-publish loop, the weekly delta report, and the API access on Dominate tier.

Olivia drives the multi-account management features, the shareable scan reports, and the agency partner programme.

Karim drives the 12-week pilot framework, the security and compliance posture, and the case-study generation programme.

When we say “no” to a feature, it is typically because none of the four personas above clearly benefit. When we say “yes,” it is typically because at least two of them benefit and at least one of them would churn without it.